

Consolidated Passes

A single operational readout of the player-experience, world-canon, audio, and visual passes completed against the current prototype family.

PLAYER VERDICT

The combat loop is strongest when the player sees the threat, owns the opening move, and reads the consequence immediately.

52

SFX CUES WIRED
4 VARIANTS EACH

41

CANON DOCUMENTS
LOADED

The game has a proven spark; integration discipline is now the bottleneck

When the opening encounter is staged correctly, Brutus already delivers a readable, reactive combat story in seconds.

Best observed sequence: a Skulker notices Brutus at close range; both allies hold; Bulwark Slam braces through the enemy's quick strike; the counter lands for 27 and ends the fight. Notice, choice, defense, and payoff all read cleanly.

3

PLAYER TEST PASSES

Baseline v2.7.1, focused unified prototype, and current v2.7.1.2.

6

P0 IMAGES GENERATED

Party busts plus the three current enemy archetypes.

4

CORE LEGIBILITY FIXES

Energy values, target clearing, contact cue, and ally hold-fire.

THE RELEASE DECISION

Do not start another broad content pass yet. First produce one canonical playable that combines the accepted combat refinements, reviewed art, and audited sound without rebuilding around a different source lineage.

GATE	WHAT MUST BE TRUE	STATUS
Player ownership	The first enemy appears in a readable space and allies cannot resolve the encounter before the player's committed opening action.	OPEN
Event integrity	Death cancels queued attacks and interrupts; no corpse whiffs or post-kill credits appear in the log.	OPEN
Asset acceptance	Audio is heard in a real browser, visuals are reviewed in context, and the merged build is diffed against the canonical source.	VERIFY

Successive tests converged on who owns first contact

PASS 1 V2.7.1

The full loop worked, but combat happened without the player

Overworld turns, deployment, descent, 3D movement, cards, ally attacks, interrupts, enrage, death, and bestiary unlocks all executed without fatal errors. The first Skulker died to Ember and Wren before it was seen or struck by Brutus.

Also found: no numeric energy value, stale target text, input actions with no feedback, log spam, weak wayfinding, and a player-facing development control.

PASS 2 UNIFIED

Legibility improved, but the timer protected input - not impact

Energy values, target clearing, the contact flash, and a 1.5-second ally hold all worked. A Quick Strike committed after contact still resolved too late: Wren killed the target during the lunge and the player's card whiffed.

Measured edge case: allies could hit an unaware target before the contact cue, claiming the opening bonus the feature was meant to reserve for the player.

PASS 3 V2.7.1.2

The intended opening can now feel excellent - but spawn luck still decides whether it happens

The current build contains ally spotting, hold-fire, numeric energy, and clean target-panel hiding. One run produced the ideal brace-and-counter tutorial beat; another let allies kill an unseen Skulker off-screen.

Newly visible: an interrupt can print after the death line, an ally can fire at the corpse, and long traversal gaps can drain tension.

Consolidated design call: make first contact a state, not a timer. On the first encounter of a fresh dungeon, present a visible enemy, cue it, hold ally fire, and release the allies only after Brutus's first committed action resolves, whiffs, or is interrupted.

STILL UNVERIFIED IN THE CURRENT BUILD

- Brute brace-breaking loop
- Deeper floors and transitions
- Energy-drain rescale
- Trap behavior and ally avoidance
- Save/load continuity
- Extended balance across enemy types

CURRENT PLAYABLE

Preserve the combat story; remove the moments that make it feel automated

RANK	PLAYER-FACING ISSUE	ACCEPTANCE CRITERION	LEAD
1	First-contact spawn luck	A fresh dungeon's opening enemy is visible or deliberately revealed; allies cannot finish it before Brutus's opening commitment resolves.	Kavi validates; combat owner implements
2	Post-kill actions	Death atomically clears target references, wind-ups, projectiles, interrupts, and queued log entries for that enemy.	GPT integration; Claude review
3	Empty traversal	Long walks carry anticipation: readable route cues, encounter breadcrumbs, or authored spacing - not merely more random spawns.	Grok tension pass; Kavi tests
4	Combat coverage gaps	A test route reliably reaches Brute, Stalker, traps, floor transition, and save/load without depending on random regeneration.	GPT test harness

What is already worth protecting

READABLE COMMITMENT

Card damage, wind-up, and recovery make choices understandable. Whiffs are explained. Heavy attacks visibly ask for timing.

REACTIVE SYSTEMS

Armor, brace, interruption, enrage, displacement, and ally reactions create stories instead of flat damage exchanges.

SEAMLESS TRANSITION

Cards stay live in spatial exploration; there is no separate battle trigger. The dungeon retains continuity.

STRONG MICRO-WRITING

The log communicates state in flavorful language. Cleaning ordering and spam will make its best lines land harder.

Player-feel principle: allies should make Brutus look capable, not make him optional. Their best behavior is to frame an opportunity, reinforce the player's decision, and finish only after the player has participated.

The world bible now reflects the real canon set

All 41 source documents - Docs 00 through 39 plus Visuals - are loaded into the Brutus Project. Claude rebuilt the earlier thin draft as **Brutus world bible v2**, keeping the source's distinction between Tier A designer-confirmed material and Tier B proposals.

SUBSTANTIVE COVERAGE

- Seven nations with values, dealbreakers, and political relationships
- Brutus, Cassius, Abel, Freja, and Varvara
- A scripted opening sequence
- Maximum-spoiler Abel reveal and godhood race
- World tone, philosophy, and narrative doctrine

WHAT THE SOURCE CLARIFIED

- The Shackle, forced marriage, and earlier ascension mechanics do not appear in the 40 numbered docs and should not be carried as canon.
- The guild economy and territorial political layer are more likely separate concepts; the canon set uses faction and territory vocabulary, not guilds.

CREATOR RULINGS STILL REQUIRED

QUESTION	CURRENT EVIDENCE	NEEDED RULING
Is Brutus lazy or brave and reckless?	The source itself leaves the conflict open. The cleanest reading is that "lazy" is Abel's dismissive perception, not objective fact.	Confirm the point-of-view interpretation or define the intended contradiction.
Island, continent, or archipelago?	The canon docs use incompatible geographic frames without adjudicating them.	Select the macro-geography that future maps and political writing must follow.
Why did weaker Brutus outperform a stronger one?	Doc 33 elevates this as a central unresolved mystery in the Abel thread.	Keep it as an authored mystery with constraints, or decide the causal answer.

Operational status: v2 exists as a chat attachment but has not been verified inside the Project file list. Upload it there before treating it as the standing bible. Claude's code-edit pause remains sensible until the canonical build lineage and ownership manifest are settled.

The audio system is broad and wired; the sounds still need to be heard

52

PROCEDURAL CUES

4x

VARIATION PER CUE

208

WAVEFORM CHECKS PASSED

P0 - COMBAT GRAMMAR

- Light, medium, heavy, and Resolute impacts
- Guard, brace absorb, stance break, interrupt, and perfect counter
- Knockback, collision, stun, player damage, and ally down
- Enemy wind-ups, attack release or miss, frenzy, and enrage

P1 - ACTIONS AND IDENTITY

- Draw, reshuffle, accepted play, rejection, and lunge
- Firebolt, Arrow, Thrown Knife, Smite, Javelin, and Shield Bash
- Weak Cure and Second Wind
- Fire, lightning, frost, poison, holy, shadow, and ward absorption

INTEGRATION FEATURES

The pass includes volume and mute controls, priority mixing, and cancellation on interrupt or pause. Party and equipment imports, the overworld, and shell routing were intentionally left unchanged.

EVIDENCE AND RISK

CHECK	RESULT	MEANING
Baseline comparisons	30 PASSED	The reconstructed assembler reproduces the supplied baseline structurally.
Waveform checks	208 PASSED	The generated cues exist and meet programmatic expectations.
Real-browser listening	NOT COMPLETED	No one has yet judged loudness, fatigue, masking, timing, or tonal fit by ear.
Canonical source diff	REQUIRED	The original build script was missing; GPT recovered embedded sources and recreated the assembler.

Deliverables in the Work conversation: rebuilt *brutus.html*, *sfx-review.html*, and *brutus-sfx-source-handoff.zip*. P2 dungeon ambience and P3 overworld interface sounds remain queued.

The first art set exists, but the visual language is still provisional

No formal art bible was found in the material Grok reviewed. The working direction was therefore inferred from the prototype palette, Brutus's written description, and a chunky 16-bit SNES/Genesis-style pixel treatment.

P0 GENERATED

- Brutus party bust
- Ember party bust
- Wren party bust
- Skulker enemy art
- Brute enemy art
- Stalker enemy art

UNDEFINED BEFORE ACCEPTANCE

- Ember's canonical appearance
- Wren's canonical appearance
- The exact look of the Gilded Sepulchre
- Bestiary canon beyond the three implemented archetypes
- How the pixel treatment scales across overworld and dungeon views

PRIORITIZED GRAPHICS BACKLOG

TIER	CONTENTS	STATUS
P0	Three party busts and three current enemies	GENERATED; NOT ACCEPTED IN-GAME
P1	Sepulchre key art, trap icons, and art-only faces for the five current cards	NOT STARTED
P2	Control-button art and HUD/panel treatment	NOT STARTED
P3	Additional enemies, deeper-floor looks, and overworld injury plates	NOT STARTED

Merge status: the six images currently live in the Grok conversation. The attempted *grok/art-p0* push was blocked by read-only GitHub access. Reauthorization was started, but no successful branch push or prototype wiring has been verified.

ACCEPTANCE STANDARD

Review the six assets together, not one by one. Brutus, Ember, Wren, and the enemies should share silhouette density, value range, outline weight, palette logic, and apparent pixel scale. Canon approval for Ember and Wren must precede downstream card and narrative art.

One controlled integration pass should come before more content

- 1. **Freeze the source lineage.** Name the canonical source package for the next playable and diff GPT's reconstructed audio build against it. Preserve the current v2.7.1.2 player behavior unless a reviewed change says otherwise.
- 2. **Land work on branches, not in chats.** Export Grok's six images and GPT's source handoff; merge each as a separate, reviewable change. Keep Claude's prototype edits as a reference patch until ownership is explicit.
- 3. **Resolve the three player blockers.** Deterministic first contact, atomic death cleanup, and intentional traversal pacing must be addressed before P2/P3 content expands the surface area.
- 4. **Run acceptance in a real browser.** Listen to every high-frequency combat cue, inspect the six sprites at play size, and run the complete route from overworld to deeper dungeon and save/load.
- 5. **Publish the standing documents.** Upload world bible v2 to the Project and ratify a one-page ownership manifest. Keep canon, implementation contracts, and agent responsibilities as separate documents.

OWNERSHIP FOR THE NEXT PASS

LANE	LEAD	BOUNDARY
Player experience and release verdict	Kavi	Runs the exact candidate build, reports player impact, and approves no implementation by assumption.
World canon and scope review	Claude	Maintains the world bible and reviews scope; no code edits until file ownership is ratified.
Visual production and dungeon tension	Grok	Creates and integrates art within the visual lane; does not change card math, frame data, or shared bridge contracts.
Audio, integration, tests, and glue	GPT	Wires accepted assets and tests the build; no unilateral shared-contract changes and no redesign of open canon.
Canon rulings and final approval	Robert	Chooses the canonical build, settles unresolved lore, and signs off on the ownership manifest.

Definition of the next candidate: a single source-backed build in which the player always participates in first contact, dead targets cannot act, combat audio has been heard and tuned, P0 art has been reviewed at game scale, and the complete route passes both scripted smoke checks and a manual player run.